

CENTRE STATE AND INTER STATE RELATIONS

FOUR-DIMENSIONAL CONSTITUTIONAL MAP → LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE AND STATE-FIELD → DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE → ADMINISTRATIVE COOPERATION AND CENTRAL → ARTICLES 355-365 AND JUDICIAL → FISCAL ARCHITECTURE FROM TAX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 FOUR-DIMENSIONAL CONSTITUTIONAL MAP

FOUR-DIMENSIONAL CONSTITUTIONAL MAP CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS ARTICLES 245-255 AND SEVENTH SCHEDULE ARTICLES 256-263 ARTICLES 265-293 PLUS 246A ARTICLES 261-263 AND 301-307 IDENTIFY FIELD CONSTITUTIONAL ROUTE

CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS

LEGISLATIVE: Articles 245-255 and Seventh Schedule

ADMINISTRATIVE: Articles 256-263

FINANCIAL: Articles 265-293 plus 246A / 269A / 279A

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS
- LEGISLATIVE: Articles 245-255 and Seventh Schedule
- ADMINISTRATIVE: Articles 256-263

POWER / PROCEDURE

- FINANCIAL: Articles 265-293 plus 246A / 269A / 279A
- INTER-STATE / MARKET: Articles 261-263 and 301-307
- METHOD: identify field → constitutional route → check → remedy.

CHECK / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Keep four owned dimensions separate: legislative relations under Articles
- 245-255, administrative relations under Articles 256-263 and 355/365, financial relations under
- Articles 268-293, and inter-State coordination under Articles 261-263 and 301-307.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- FINANCIAL: Articles 265-293 plus 246A / 269A / 279A

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 245-255, administrative relations under Articles 256-263 and 355/365, financial relations under Articles 268-293, and inter-State coordination under Articles 261-263 and 301-307.

01

STAGE 01 LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE AND STATE-FIELD ENTRY

LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE AND STATE-FIELD ENTRY COMPETENCE FIRST ARTICLE 245 REACH ARTICLE 246 LISTS ARTICLE 248 RESIDUE UNION 100 STATE 61 CONCURRENT 52

COMPETENCE FIRST

Article 245 reach → Article 246 lists → Article 248 residue

Union 100

State 61

Concurrent 52

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COMPETENCE FIRST
- Article 245 reach → Article 246 lists → Article 248 residue
- Union 100
- State 61

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Concurrent 52
- Article 246A: special GST competence
- PARLIAMENT IN STATE FIELD
- 249 Rajya Sabha

CHECK / LIMIT

- 250 Emergency
- 252 State request
- 253 treaty
- 356 breakdown

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Each route has a separate trigger, duration and amendment consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Each route has a separate trigger, duration and amendment consequence.

02

STAGE 02 DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE BILLS

DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE BILLS TRUE NATURE CONFLICT PITH AND SUBSTANCE HARMONIOUS CONSTRUCTION ARTICLE 254 REPUGNANCY M. KARUNANIDHI (1979) REAL, DIRECT AND IRRECONCILABLE CONCURRENT-FIELD CONFLICT STATE BILL CONTROLS PRIOR PRESIDENTIAL SANCTION

TRUE NATURE → ENTRY → RECONCILIATION → CONFLICT pith and substance → harmonious construction →

M. Karunanidhi (1979): real, direct and irreconcilable Concurrent-field conflict

STATE BILL CONTROLS prior presidential sanction != Governor reservation under Article 200

Article 201 presidential consideration; no automatic assent after State reconsideration.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- TRUE NATURE → ENTRY → RECONCILIATION → CONFLICT pith and substance → harmonious construction → Article 254 repugnancy
- M. Karunanidhi (1979): real, direct and irreconcilable Concurrent-field conflict

POWER / PROCEDURE

- STATE BILL CONTROLS prior presidential sanction != Governor reservation under Article 200
- Article 201 presidential consideration; no automatic assent after State reconsideration.

CHECK / LIMIT

- TRUE NATURE → ENTRY → RECONCILIATION → CONFLICT pith and substance → harmonious construction → Article 254 repugnancy
- M. Karunanidhi (1979): real, direct and irreconcilable Concurrent-field conflict

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- STATE BILL CONTROLS prior presidential sanction != Governor reservation under Article 200
- Article 201 presidential consideration; no automatic assent after State reconsideration.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 201 presidential consideration; no automatic assent after State reconsideration.

- STATE BILL CONTROLS prior presidential sanction != Governor reservation under Article 200
- Article 201 presidential consideration; no automatic assent after State reconsideration.

03

RAJYA SABHA ROUTE FOR IAS

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 2024 West Bengal ruling: Article 131 suit maintainable at preliminary stage, merits open.
- ARTICLES 256-257

04

ARTICLE 360 SEPARATE FINANCIAL-EMERGENCY ROUTE

STATE OF RAJASTHAN (1977)

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- State of Rajasthan (1977) → review not wholly excluded
- S.R. Bommai (1994) → federalism, review and floor-test discipline.

05

ANY-PUBLIC-PURPOSE GRANTS

271 → Union surcharge outside sharing

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Article 254 repugnancy is principally a Concurrent-List conflict rule
- pith and substance tests competence, Article 262 permits statutory exclusion for defined river disputes, and Article 263 creates

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 254 repugnancy is principally a Concurrent-List conflict rule; pith and substance tests competence, Article 262 permits statutory exclusion for defined river disputes, and Article 263 creates an enabling power rather than a self-executing adjudicatory council.

06

41% VERTICAL SHARE HORIZONTAL WEIGHTS INCLUDE INCOME DISTANCE, DEMOGRAPHY

Union one-third votes

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

06

STAGE 06 FISCAL EVOLUTION, SIXTEENTH FINANCE COMMISSION AND GST

FISCAL EVOLUTION, SIXTEENTH FINANCE COMMISSION AND GST

PLAN ERA

NITI ERA

PLANNING COMMISSION DISCRETION

NITI HAS NO DEVOLUTION POWER

SIXTEENTH FINANCE COMMISSION 2026-31

41% VERTICAL SHARE HORIZONTAL WEIGHTS INCLUDE INCOME DISTANCE, DEMOGRAPHY

ARTICLES 246A + 269A + 279A

PLAN ERA → FC / GST / NITI ERA

Planning Commission discretion → NITI has no devolution power

Sixteenth Finance Commission 2026-31 → 41% vertical share horizontal weights include income distance, demography, ecology

GST: Articles 246A + 269A + 279A

Union one-third votes

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PLAN ERA → FC / GST / NITI ERA
- Planning Commission discretion → NITI has no devolution power

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Sixteenth Finance Commission 2026-31 → 41% vertical share horizontal weights include income distance, demography, ecology and GDP contribution
- GST: Articles 246A + 269A + 279A

CHECK / LIMIT

- Union one-third votes
- States two-thirds

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- three-fourths decision threshold
- Mohit Minerals (2022): Council recommendations are recommendatory, not binding.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mohit Minerals (2022): Council recommendations are recommendatory, not binding.

07

STAGE 07 RIVER-WATER DISPUTE ROUTE AND JURISDICTION

RIVER-WATER DISPUTE ROUTE AND JURISDICTION

ARTICLE 262 + 1956 ACT NEGOTIATION

DISPUTE-SPECIFIC TRIBUNAL

PARLIAMENT MAY EXCLUDE COURT JURISDICTION OVER THE DEFINED WATER

ARTICLE 131 DOES NOT DISPLACE THE SPECIAL ARTICLE 262

CURRENT CONTROL

2019 AMENDMENT BILL LAPSED WITH THE SEVENTEENTH LOK SABHA

A REVISED PERMANENT-TRIBUNAL PROPOSAL IS NOT ENACTED LAW

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 262 + 1956 ACT negotiation → dispute-specific tribunal → publication → implementation
- Parliament may exclude court jurisdiction over the defined water dispute

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 131 does not displace the special Article 262 statutory bar
- CURRENT CONTROL

CHECK / LIMIT

- 2019 Amendment Bill lapsed with the Seventeenth Lok Sabha
- A revised permanent-tribunal proposal is not enacted law

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Cauvery implementation uses the 2018 Scheme and management institutions.
- ARTICLE 262 + 1956 ACT negotiation → dispute-specific tribunal → publication → implementation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cauvery implementation uses the 2018 Scheme and management institutions.

08

STAGE 08 INTERGOVERNMENTAL FORUMS AND CURRENT OPERATION

INTERGOVERNMENTAL FORUMS AND CURRENT OPERATION

ARTICLE 263 INTER-STATE COUNCIL

PRESIDENT ESTABLISHES WHEN PUBLIC INTEREST REQUIRES; INQUIRY, DISCUSSION, RECOMMENDATION

1990 PRESIDENTIAL ORDER

PM CHAIR

ZONAL COUNCILS

FIVE STATUTORY COUNCILS UNDER STATES REORGANISATION ACT 1956

HOME MINISTER CHAIR

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 263 INTER-STATE COUNCIL
- President establishes when public interest requires; inquiry, discussion, recommendation
- 1990 presidential order

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PM chair
- ZONAL COUNCILS
- Five statutory councils under States Reorganisation Act 1956

CHECK / LIMIT

- Home Minister chair
- NEC is separate under 1971 Act, not a sixth Zonal Council
- 2026 official activity: Central, Northern, Eastern and Southern zonal mechanisms.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- PM chair

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2026 official activity: Central, Northern, Eastern and Southern zonal mechanisms.

09

STAGE 09 COMMON MARKET, RECOGNITION AND LAYERED REGULATION

COMMON MARKET, RECOGNITION AND LAYERED REGULATION

ARTICLE 261

RECOGNITION OF PUBLIC ACTS, RECORDS AND PROCEEDINGS; CIVIL EXECUTION

ARTICLES 301-304

FREE TRADE WITH BOUNDED REGULATION AND NON-DISCRIMINATION

JINDAL STAINLESS (2016)

NO TAX-FREE PROMISE; ARTICLE 304(A) TARGETS DISCRIMINATION

MINOR MINERALS

ARTICLE 261 → recognition of public acts, records and proceedings; civil execution

ARTICLES 301-304 → free trade with bounded regulation and non-discrimination

Jindal Stainless (2016): no tax-free promise; Article 304(a) targets discrimination

MINOR MINERALS

MMDR Section 3(e) Centre notifies category

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 261 → recognition of public acts, records and proceedings; civil execution
- ARTICLES 301-304 → free trade with bounded regulation and non-discrimination

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Jindal Stainless (2016): no tax-free promise; Article 304(a) targets discrimination
- MINOR MINERALS

CHECK / LIMIT

- MMDR Section 3(e) Centre notifies category
- Section 15 States make concession rules → layered power, not State exclusion.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 261 → recognition of public acts, records and proceedings; civil execution
- ARTICLES 301-304 → free trade with bounded regulation and non-discrimination

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Section 15 States make concession rules → layered power, not State exclusion.

- ARTICLE 261 → recognition of public acts, records and proceedings; civil execution
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- ARTICLE 261 → recognition of public acts, records and proceedings; civil execution
- ARTICLES 301-304 → free trade with bounded regulation and non-discrimination

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Section 15 States make concession rules → layered power, not State exclusion.

10

STAGE 10 COMMISSIONS, ELEVEN PYQS AND PRELIMS FIREWALLS

COMMISSIONS, ELEVEN PYQS AND PRELIMS FIREWALLS REFORM EVIDENCE STATE AUTONOMY COOPERATIVE SAFEGUARDS MODERN MACHINERY ELEVEN PYQ ROUTES 2019 DOCTRINES 2020 CENTRALISATION

REFORM EVIDENCE

Rajamannar → State autonomy → Sarkaria → cooperative safeguards → Punchhi → modern machinery

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- REFORM EVIDENCE
- Rajamannar → State autonomy
- Sarkaria → cooperative safeguards
- Punchhi → modern machinery

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ELEVEN PYQ ROUTES
- 2019 doctrines
- 2020 centralisation
- 2021 CBI

CHECK / LIMIT

- 2022 parties/autonomy
- 2023 Article 356 + GST
- 2024 relations reform + list trap
- 2025 fiscal federalism + constitutional-body + minor-mineral traps

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- FIREWALLS: Article 365 is not automatic; GST is not a Concurrent-list tax entry
- Zonal Councils are statutory; the 2019 water Bill is not law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2023 Article 356 + GST | 2024 relations reform + list trap.

11

STAGE 11 MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED VERDICT 10 MARKS 2-3 ANCHORS 15 MARKS 20 MARKS LEGISLATIVE + ADMINISTRATIVE + FISCAL + INTER-STATE EVIDENCE CHAIN CLAIM STATE/UNION COUNTERPOINT

10 MARKS: definition → 2-3 anchors → qualification → verdict → 15 MARKS: thesis → dimensions → evidence/case → counterpoint → reform → 20 MARKS: legislative + administrative + fiscal + inter-State → diagnosis → reform → EVIDENCE CHAIN claim → Article/institution → operation → State/Union counterpoint → commission remedy → Strong Union power is constitutionally bounded

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- 10 MARKS: definition → 2-3 anchors → qualification → verdict
- 15 MARKS: thesis → dimensions → evidence/case → counterpoint → reform
- 20 MARKS: legislative + administrative + fiscal + inter-State → diagnosis → reform

POWER / PROCEDURE

- EVIDENCE CHAIN claim → Article/institution → operation → State/Union counterpoint → commission remedy
- Strong Union power is constitutionally bounded
- durable relations require consultation before compulsion, predictable finance, shared data and reviewable discretion.

CHECK / LIMIT

- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Special Reference No.
- 1 of 2025 rejects rigid judicial timelines and deemed assent, recognises Article 200 discretion, and permits only a
- Do not continue the displaced April

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 2025 timeline rule.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: definition → 2-3 anchors → qualification → verdict.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 19. REPRESENTATION AS A FOURTH CENTRE-STATE DIMENSION - OPTIONAL 20. EXECUTIVE FEDERALISM AND INSTITUTIONAL UNDER-USE - OPTIONAL STATE INFLUENCE AT THE UNION DEPENDS NOT ONLY ON THE 42ND, 84TH AND 87TH AMENDMENT SEQUENCE SEPARATED INTER-STATE [CURRENT] THE 2026 DELIMITATION PACKAGE WAS DEFEATED; ITS PROPOSED [ANALYSIS] REPRESENTATION AND DEVOLUTION ARE TWO CURRENCIES OF THE [LIMIT] FULL REPRESENTATIONAL-FEDERALISM TREATMENT BELONGS TO POLITY 12 AND

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- 19. Representation as a fourth Centre-State dimension - optional
- 20. Executive federalism and institutional under-use - optional
- State influence at the Union depends not only on Lists and transfers but on seats in Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha and the Presidential Electoral College.
- The 42nd, 84th and 87th Amendment sequence separated inter-State seat allocation freeze from permissible intra-State boundary readjustment.

ADVANCED LIMIT

- [CURRENT] The 2026 delimitation package was defeated; its proposed 850-seat figure is not law.
- [ANALYSIS] Representation and devolution are two currencies of the same grievance where population growth affects both political and fiscal weight.
- [LIMIT] Full representational-federalism treatment belongs to Polity 12 and Parliament; no seat projection or implementation date should be invented.
- Much Indian federal coordination occurs among Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, ministers and officials rather than through legislatures.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Executive federalism can respond quickly but may weaken transparency and opposition participation.
- Zonal mechanisms often solve operational questions; the ISC should address national structural disputes.
- A stronger ISC secretariat, regular agenda cycle and response-to-recommendation duty would turn consultation into accountable process.
- Executive federalism and institutional under-use - optional - Much Indian federal coordination occurs

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.